



were. They, too, were usually slaves, or former slaves who had been granted their freedom. Some became rich and famous because they won many races, such as Pompeius Musclosus, who had 3,559 victories! The

charioteers belonged to different racing clubs (*factiones* or *factions*), which were cheered on by fans, just as sports teams are today. There were only four clubs, and the charioteers wore the colors of their team. The *Albati* team wore white, the *Russati* wore red, the *Prasini* was the green team, and blue was the color of the *Veneti*.

---

CHARIOTS RACED AROUND A LONG PLINTH IN THE MIDDLE OF THE CIRCUS MAXIMUS.

